EXECUTIVE SUMMARY FOR SCHOOL LEADERSHIP

Ticali Trio

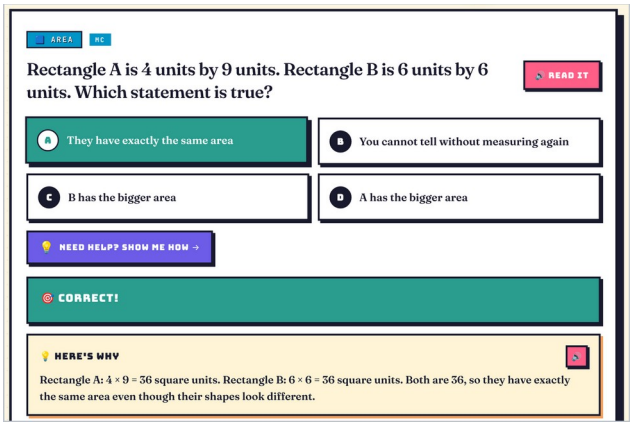
A family-made practice game based on the reading and math programs AACPS uses

From [Your name], parent · November 2026

What it is

Ticali Trio is a learning game I made for my three children in Anne Arundel County Public Schools: a kindergartener, a 3rd grader and a 5th grader. It practices this year's grade-level work in the programs AACPS uses (Amplify CKLA for reading and Reveal Math for math), explains why each answer is right, and shows those programs' methods when a child is stuck. It is a single file that opens in a web browser on a laptop or desktop. It needs no internet connection, account or sign-in, and has no ads, tracking or purchases. It has not been reviewed or endorsed by AACPS or its teachers. I am sharing it for your information and would welcome your feedback.

To try it: on a laptop or desktop, save the attached file and double-click it (details on page 2).



A 3rd grade question after a correct answer: "Here's why" explains it, and "Show me how" is one tap away.

At a glance

378	13,200+	1,179	14	40
packs, kindergarten to 5th grade, 288 of them one unit's topic	written questions, each with an explanation and step-by-step coaching	thinking puzzles	math packs with fresh questions every round	Reading Road stops, with 251 story pages and 440 questions

What it is for

1. **Follow the school year.** Each grade is laid out unit by unit, in the order class teaches it. The current unit is highlighted, estimated from the AACPS calendar (a parent can adjust it). Earlier units, and last year's work, stay open for review. **Mix & Match** builds one round from several packs.
2. **Understand, not just answer.** Every answer, right or wrong, is followed by why. On most question types, a wrong answer gets a hint and a second try.
3. **Learn it the way the programs teach it.** "Show me how" walks through the method step by step, using the question's own numbers and words (for example, make a ten, the area model, arm blending, look back in the story). Every question has it.
4. **Say each sound the way class does.** A device's voice reads /b/ as "buh", so wherever the game names a letter sound it plays a recording of that sound alone (all 44 of CKLA's), and it sounds out words sound by sound, in CKLA's terms. A kindergarten and 1st grade **Sound Lab** practices hearing, blending, counting and changing the sounds in words, the skills Maryland's K–3 reading screening checks.
5. **Think, not guess.** Puzzles ask children to pick every answer that fits, put steps in order, sort, or answer and then prove it: the kinds of items on Maryland's new MSTAR tests.
6. **Grow readers.** The Reading Road follows the order Amplify CKLA teaches the sounds, with a story at every stop (read to the child at the first five; after that, decodable using only what the Road has taught so far) and questions about each story. In kindergarten and 1st grade, every question, answer and story can be read aloud, so a child who cannot read yet can play on their own.

7. **Keep it fun and kind.** Levels, trophies, a buddy, stickers that teach a fact, daily missions, boss battles, math-fact sprints against the child's own best, and a family goal the three children reach together. Siblings are never ranked, and a wrong answer never takes progress away.

What it is based on

- **Reading and writing:** Amplify CKLA, which AACPS uses in K–5. Reading packs follow CKLA's 2nd edition units.
- **Math:** McGraw Hill Reveal Math, which AACPS uses in K–5, and Maryland's math standards revised in July 2025.
- **Science:** Maryland's NGSS-based standards. Maryland's grade 5 science test (MISA) covers grades 3–5, so 4th grade science stays available to the 5th grader.
- **Social studies:** Maryland's social studies framework, revised in 2025.
- **Tests:** formats like those on MSTAR, which replaces MCAP for grades 3–8 reading and math from spring 2027.
- **Health:** general elementary content, without family-life topics; AACPS's health sequence was not found.

How it was made, and its limits

The questions, explanations, coaching steps and stories were written by an AI assistant at my direction, working from official curriculum information that is publicly available. They were then checked by automated tests and by further AI review passes that re-solved every question.

Documents the AI assistant read in full (public PDF copies): Amplify's CKLA curriculum maps and K–5 program guide; the openly licensed Core Knowledge teacher guides CKLA is built on; McGraw Hill's Reveal Math alignment documents for grades 3–5; a Reveal Math pacing guide from a district in another state; and an AACPS family handout on math strategies.

Limits:

- It is **not an AACPS product**. AACPS, its teachers and the publishers Amplify and McGraw Hill have not reviewed or endorsed it.
- The AI assistant could not open several official websites (AACPS, MSDE, McGraw Hill, Amplify), so some details rest on search results that quote them.
- It did not use AACPS pacing guides, teacher editions or other licensed classroom materials. Math and reading units follow the published Reveal Math and CKLA order; the order of science, social studies and health units, and every unit's timing, are estimates.
- Not confirmed: which edition of Amplify CKLA (2nd or new 3rd) classrooms use this year (the reading packs follow the 2nd), and how AACPS maps Reveal Math onto Maryland's revised standards.
- The letter sounds are recordings made from an open speech model's voice, checked by measurement but not yet by a teacher's ear. **HEAR ALL 45 SOUNDS** on the parent dashboard plays them all.
- A question can still be wrong. Corrections are welcome.

Privacy

No accounts, and no names beyond "Kindergarten," "3rd Grade" and "5th Grade." Progress stays in the device's browser and is never sent anywhere. When online, the page loads typefaces from Google Fonts, and some browsers' most natural voices are online and receive the words read aloud (the game's, plus any buddy name a child types); a parent can choose a voice built into the device instead.

How to open it

- **On a laptop or desktop** (Windows, Mac or Chromebook): save the attached file, Ticali_Trio_Family_Edition.html, then double-click it. It opens in your web browser. If your email system held the file back, please let me know.
- **On an iPad,** an emailed copy opens in a preview that does not run the game, so please use a laptop or desktop.
- On the title screen, **For grown-ups: about this game** explains the game, how it was made and its limits. Below the children's cards, **Every grade, K–5** has a button for each grade: pick who is playing, or **Just looking** to try it without saving anything. The faint word **parent** at the bottom right opens the parent dashboard (PIN **0000**). Nothing you do touches the children's progress at home.

I would welcome any feedback, especially on how well it matches what is taught in your classrooms. Thank you.

[Your name], parent